Lab #1: Introduction to Laboratory Electronics

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Partners at Table: Francey, Arla, Mannu

1. Experiment Description and Prelab

1.1: Description

(Give a brief description of the experiment and objectives for context.)

In this experiment, we are to measure 2 waveforms from an Arbitrary Waveform Generator (AWG): a 50kHz sinewave, and a 200kHz square wave. Then, we have to verify that the circuit in the prelab (seen later in this document) actually behaves as we expect it to. With this section, we can experiment to find out the significance between the scope(+) and scope(-) leads. Afterwards, we will build our actual voltage divider according to the prelab design. Here, we will use three 10 kilo-Ohm resistors, and measure our actual voltage output. Account for error and error propagation! We then would find the amount of power we lose by building the circuit as such, and look for changes to reduce the amount of power lost. Then, we must find out how to change our circuit to actually function as a 3.3V supply, and then build the re-design whilst confirming it works with recorded observations.

1.2 Prelab: Voltage Divider

(Give problem statement; insert design of voltage divider and derive expression of Vout as function of R1,R2,R3 and Vin. Include circuit diagram)

In the prelab, we are to design a voltage divider to reduce a 5V source to roughly 3.3V, using 3 identical resistors. My design of the circuit, with all associated equations are as shown in the image below:

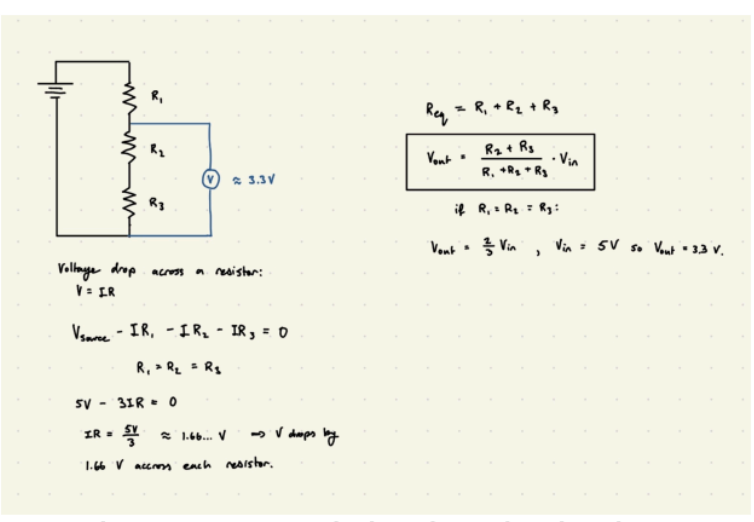


Figure 1, prelab circuit design

1.3 Prelab: AC/DC/GND

(Copy the table from the prelab, include the circuit diagram and fill it in with your reasoning)

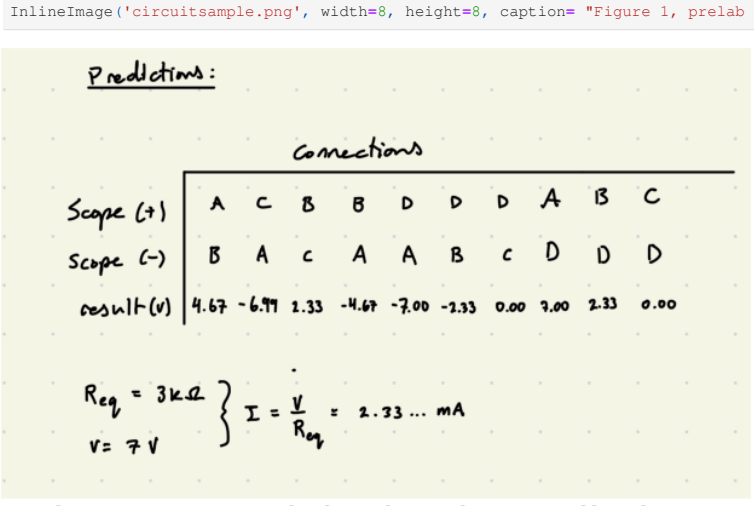


Figure 2, prelab circuit predictions

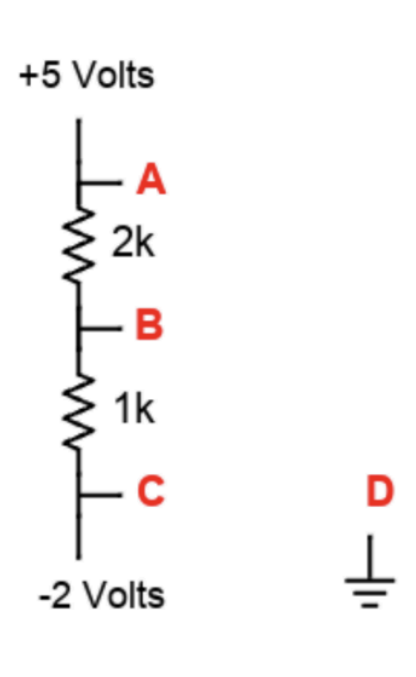
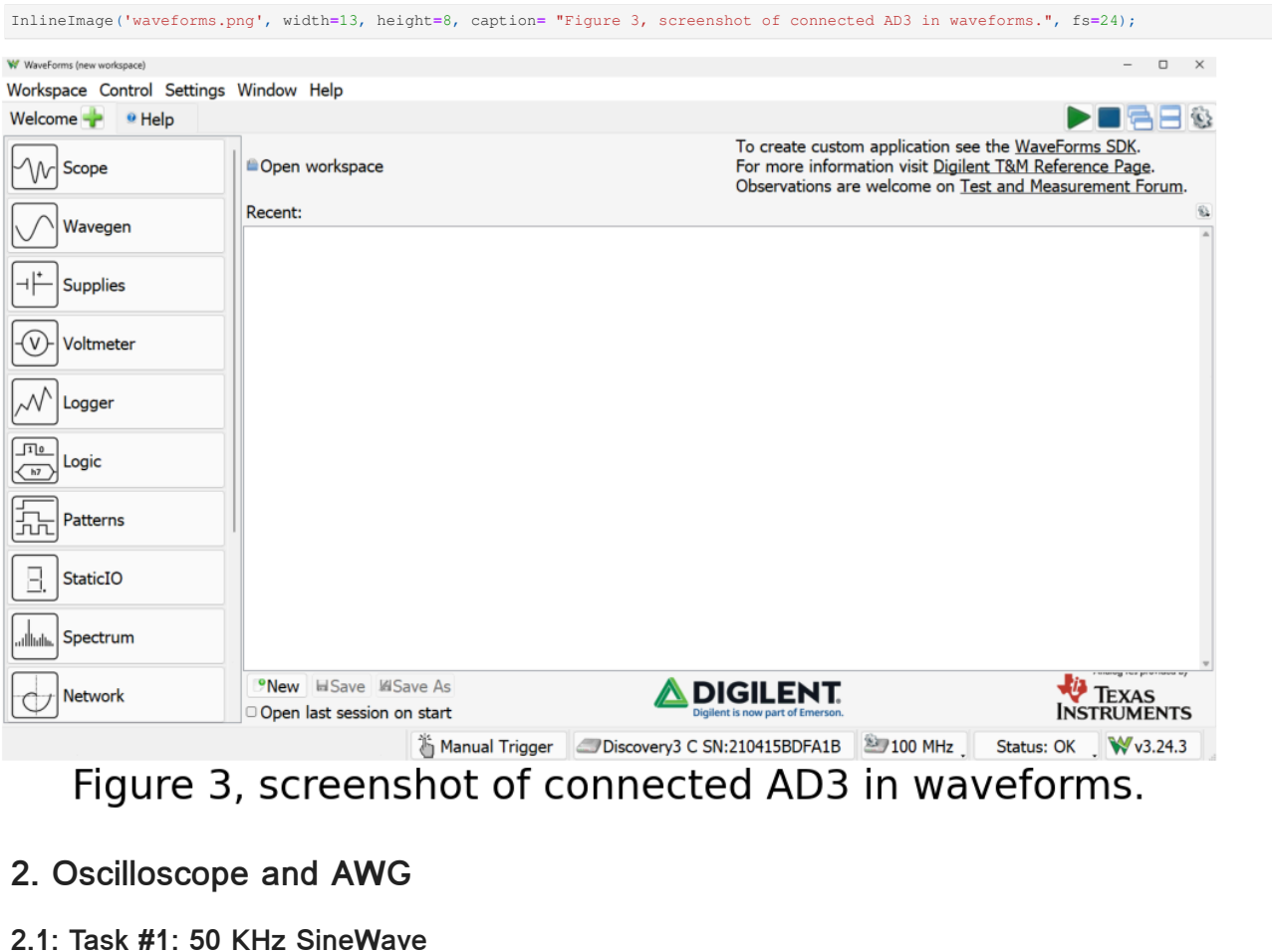


Figure 1: Simple Resistor Circuit.

Figure 1, prelab circuit design

Essentially, my predictions were off calculating the current through the circuit, and then using it to calculate the voltage drop across any set or individual resistor. However, some parts were confusing, such as the drop from B to D being the same as C to D in my predictions, even though technically C is -2V and D is ground or 0V, so there should be a difference between those two scenarios. I likewise actually looking at how it would pan out to proceed.

1.4 Prelab: Analog Discovery 2



Workspace Control Settings Window Help
Welcome
Help
Scope
Wavegen
Supplies
Voltmeter
Logger
Logic
Patterns
StaticIO
Spectrum
Network
Open workspace
Recent
To create custom application use the WaveForms SDK.
For more information visit Digilent T&M Reference Page.
Observations are welcome on Test and Measurement Forum.
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TEXAS INSTRUMENTS

Figure 3, screenshot of connected AD3 in waveforms.

2. Oscilloscope and AWG

2.1: Task #1: 50 KHz SineWave

(Describe the steps you took to setup your AD3 and the connections you made with the pins. Sketch this setup.)

To set up my AD3, I followed the guide on the AD3 website - feedback loop circuit, where I connect orange 1+ to yellow W1, and orange 1- to gnd. Pin connections shown below:

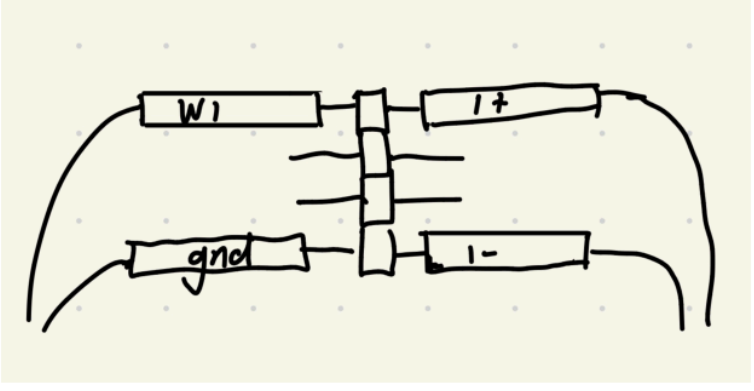
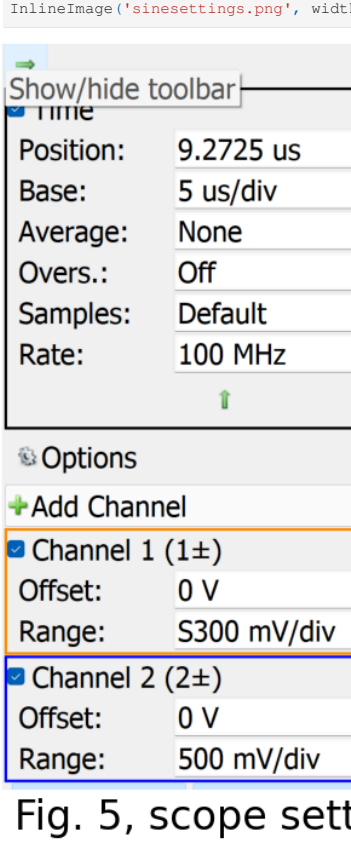


Figure 4, AD3 connections

(Describe how you took measurements and their results)

Then, I set up a 50kHz sine wave, using the following window settings:



Show/hide toolbar

Time

Position: 9.2725 us

Base: 5 us/div

Average: None

Overs.: Off

Samples: Default

Rate: 100 MHz

Options

Add Channel

Channel 1 (1±)

Offset: 0 V

Range: 5300 mV/div

Channel 2 (2±)

Offset: 0 V

Range: 500 mV/div

Fig. 5, scope settings

The measurements of the peak-peak voltage and period with the cursor are shown below:

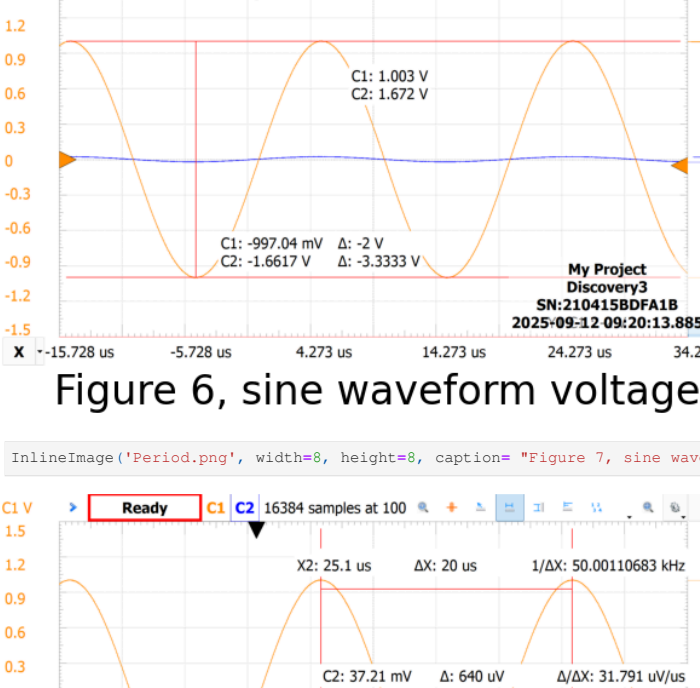


Figure 6, sine waveform voltage

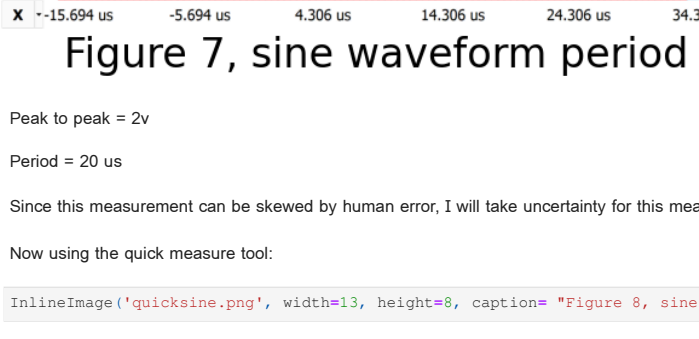


Figure 7, sine waveform period

Peak to peak = 2v

Period = 20 us

Since this measurement can be skewed by human error, I will find uncertainty for this measurement based off of the next section, the quick measurement.

Now using the quick measure tool:

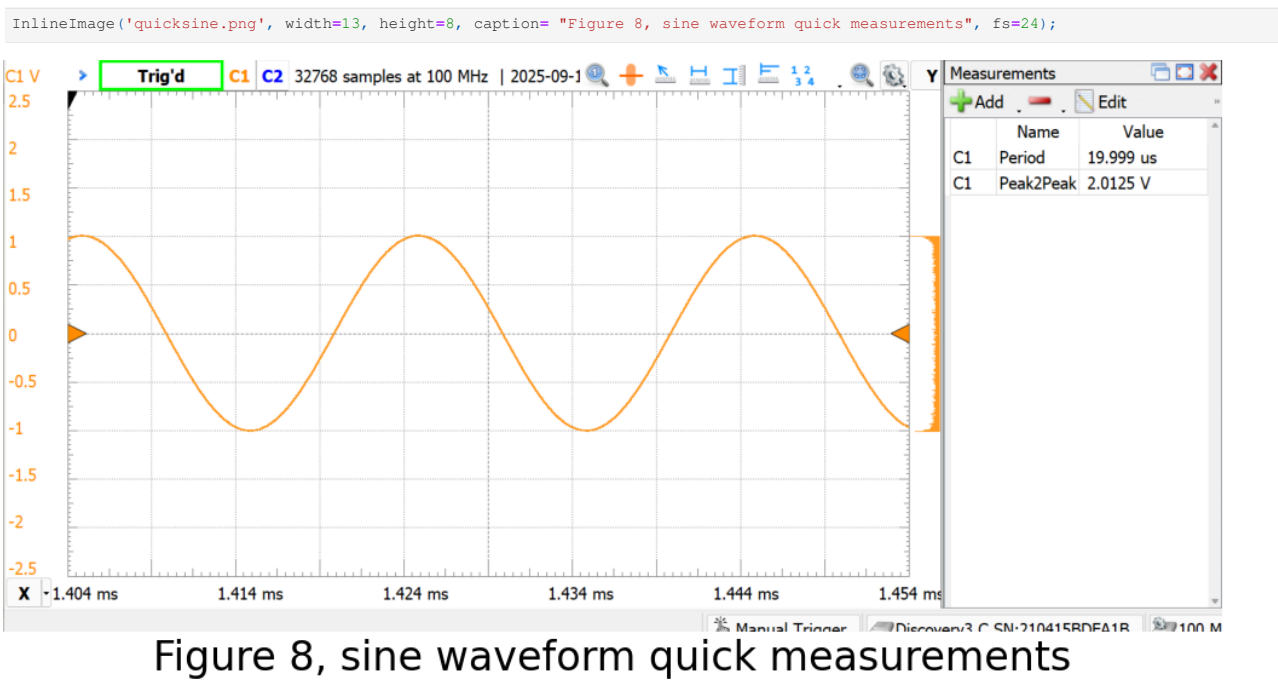


Figure 8, sine waveform quick measurements

The period would fluctuate between 19 and 20; given that it is a digital measurement, I will use the half of the range of fluctuation (the +/-) and divide by square root 3:

$$uncertainty = \frac{0.5}{sqrt(3)} = \pm 0.29867...us$$

However, due to the nature of uncertainty being, well... uncertain, I will round it to the first significant figure:

$$uncertainty_{period} = \pm 0.3us$$

The amplitude would fluctuate between 2.00 and 2.01; following the same logic as above, we obtain the uncertainty of:

$$uncertainty_{Amplitude} = \pm 0.003V$$

So:

$$Period = 19.5 \pm 0.3us, and Amplitude = 2.005 \pm 0.003V$$

These values (19.5 and 2.005) were chosen because they stayed on screen more evenly. So I picked the value in between them.

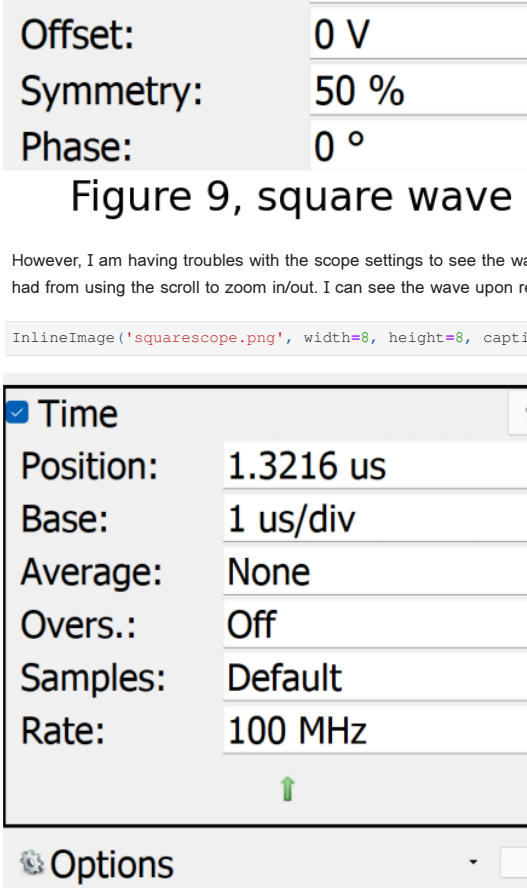
(Note any difficulties or troubles and how they were corrected)

No troubles in this task yet. I had previously tested the AD3 prior to lab time. Note: cursor feels awkward to use since it is placing 2 bars for each axis to measure.

2.2 Task #2: 200 KHz Square Wave

(Describe you adjusted the AWG to produce desired output)

To produce the 200kHz square wave, I simply switched the wave type to square, and then set the frequency to 200kHz.



Type: Square

Frequency: 200 kHz

Period: 5 us

Amplitude: 1 V

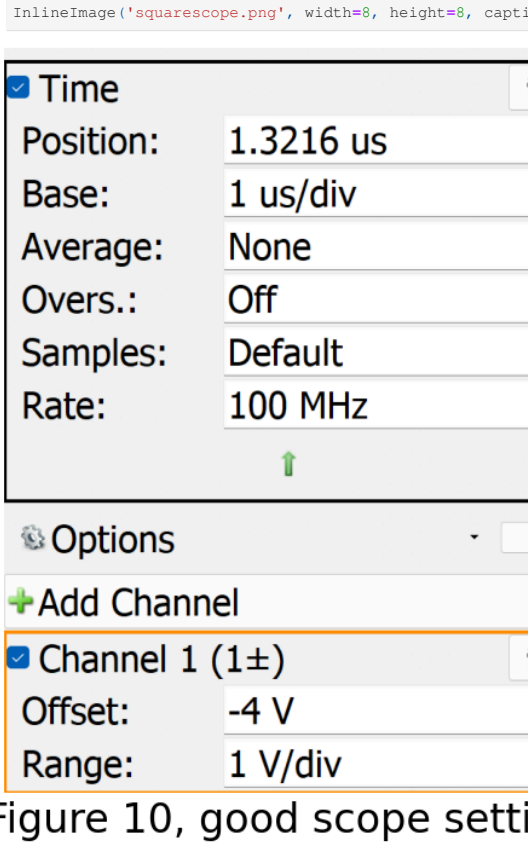
Offset: 0 V

Symmetry: 50 %

Phase: 0 °

Figure 9, square wave settings

However, I am having troubles with the scope settings to see the wave. It seems as if the wave won't show up no matter the range or base settings. Turns out, there was an offset that I had from using the scroll to zoom in/out. I can see the wave upon resetting the offset. Updated scope settings:



Time

Position: 1.3216 us

Base: 1 us/div

Average: None

Overs.: Off

Samples: Default

Rate: 100 MHz

Options

Add Channel

Channel 1 (1±)

Offset: -4 V

Range: 1 V/div

Figure 10, good scope settings

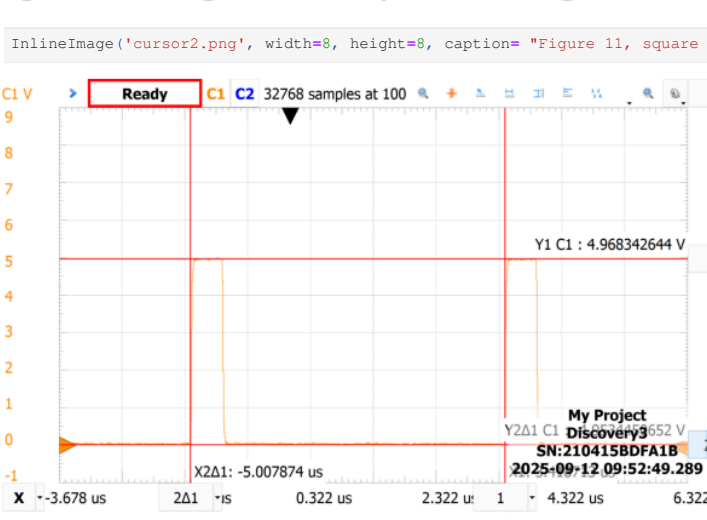


Figure 11, square waveform Period

measurements of square wave

I realized at this point in the lab that the embedded images does not work, so I have to split the cell and insert a new code section for images. Images before this point will not show up unfortunately, and I will have to reformat in my final copy.

NOTE: I will also determine uncertainties at home for the sake of time, since we only have access to resistors in lab. The waves I can recreate according to my notes at home with ease.

Below is my graph from the exported data for the square wave. NOTE: in lab, I was not able to get the data to import correctly. No matter what I and the TAs tried, the file directory could not be found. With lots of trial and error at home, and maybe find an alternative filename import method. In exporting/importing data, and also refreshed the ipynb instance. Nothing worked. For this submission, images may not be present for that reason.

POST LAB TONY HERE: I have gone through a fresh installation of python, jupyter, and all other softwares needed on my computer to use jupyter notebook through VSCode.

I realized at this point in the lab that the embedded images does not work, so I have to split the cell and insert a new code section for images. Images before this point will not show up unfortunately, and I will have to reformat in my final copy.

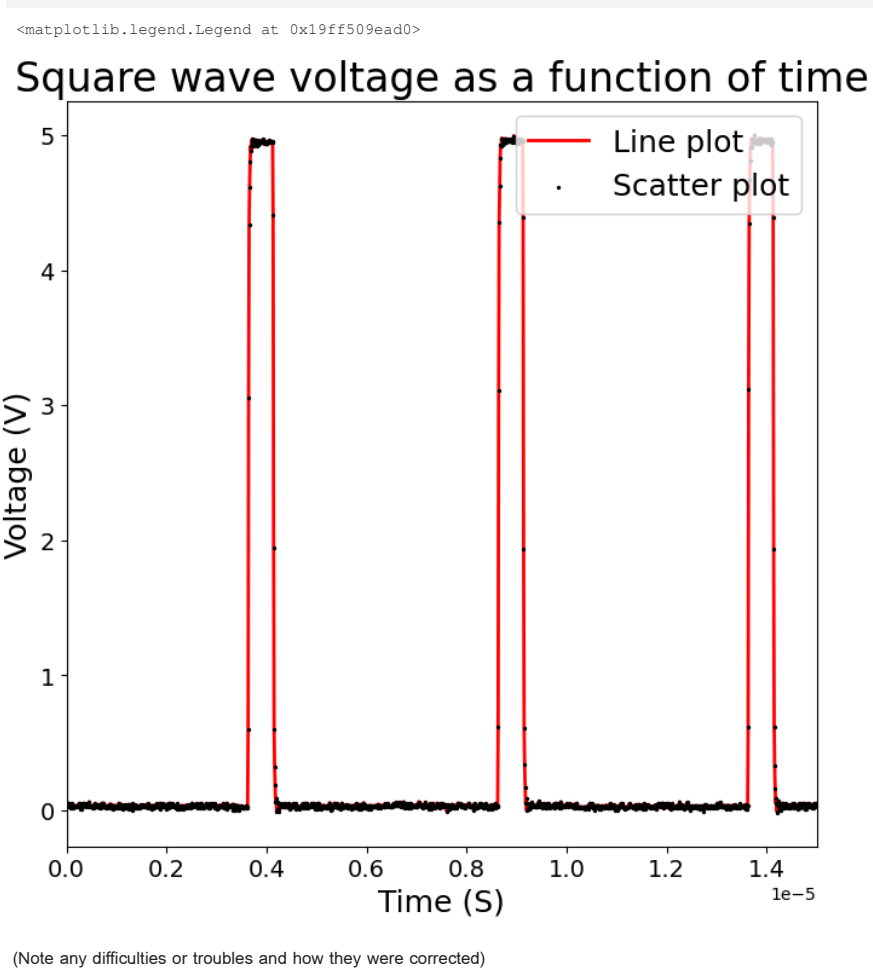
NOTE: I will also determine uncertainties at home for the sake of time, since we only have access to resistors in lab. The waves I can recreate according to my notes at home with ease.

Below is my graph from the exported data for the square wave.

NOTE: In lab, I was not able to get the data to import correctly. No matter what I and the TAs tried, the file directory could not be found. Will look into it further at home, or maybe find an alternative filename import method. We tried every directory possible, including the local and non-local directories, even re-exporting/importing data, and also refreshed the ipynb instance. Nothing worked. For this submission, images may not be present for that reason.

POST LAB TONY HERE: I have gone through a full reinstallation of everything needed to run jupyter notebook locally through visual studio code.

Now, I am able to upload the images properly as the computer seems to have no issues finding file directories now. Sadly I had to manually re-upload each one :(



(Note any difficulties or troubles and how they were corrected)

2.3 Task #3: Differential vs GND references

(Describe your results)

Pictures will be uploaded later once the problem of uploading is resolved.

For now, I will describe what I have completed with the AD3. I have created a new supply, setting the positive terminal to +5v and the negative terminal to -2V. After that, I can set up the breadboard corresponding to how the image in the prelab, Fig. 1 shows. The measurement arranged low values were used to obtain an average of the voltage reading between the 1+ and 1- scope probes.

POST LAB TONY HERE: The circuit diagram is now shown below, with a picture of the breadboard.

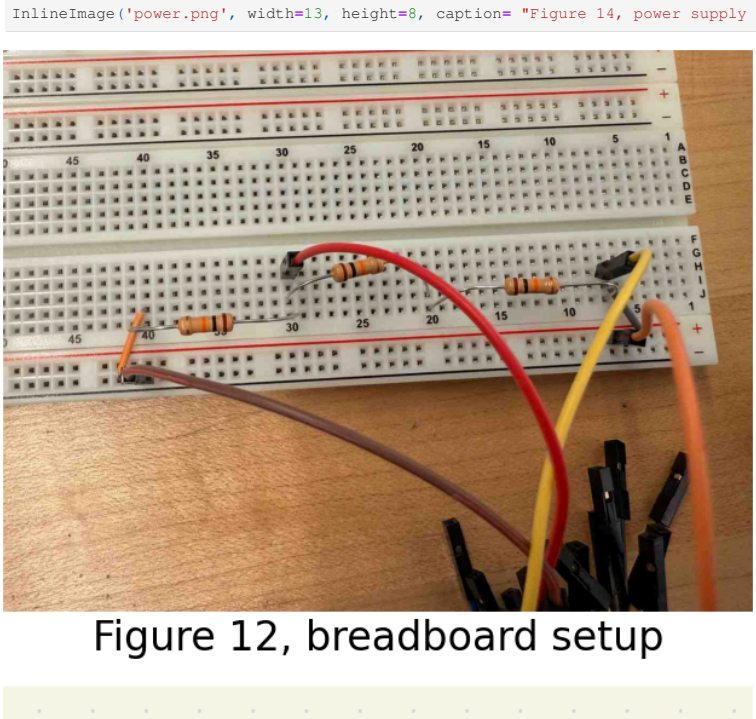


Figure 12, breadboard setup

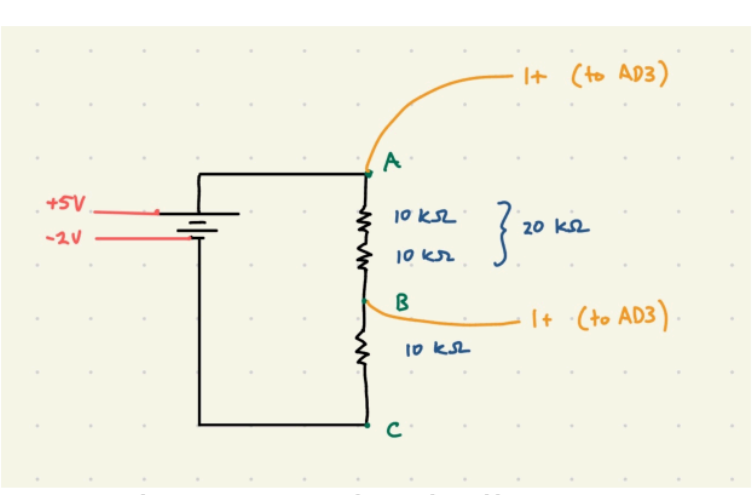


Figure 13, circuit diagram

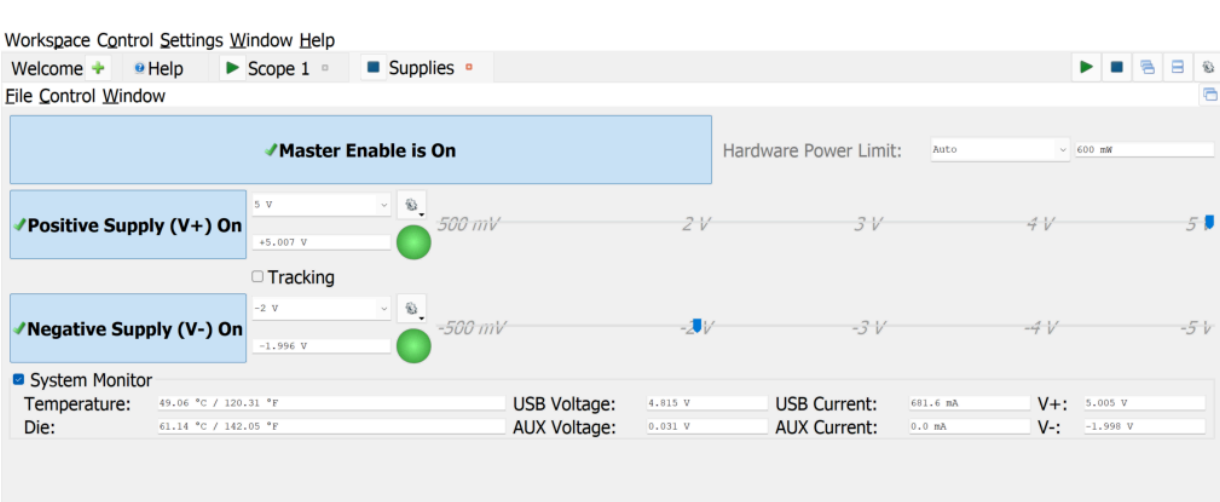
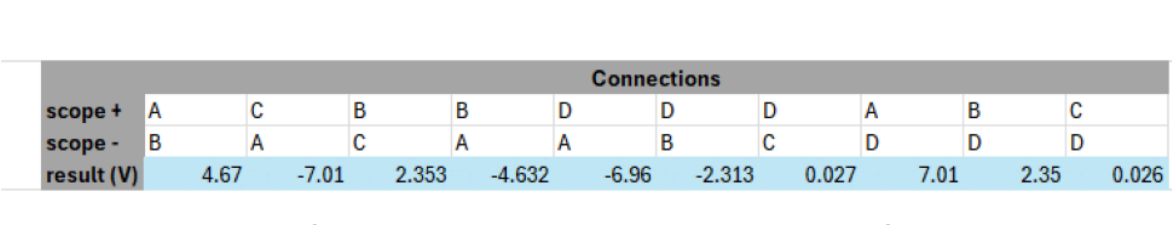


Figure 14, power supply settings

Initially, I set the position of the 1+ and 1- probes reversed, and my correct settings did not reflect on the readings. The reading were of the negatives [illegible] way to get the positive readings was to [illegible]

My results from the actual measurements of the circuit are shown below:



Connections							
scope +	A	C	B	D	A	B	C
scope -	B	A	C	A	D	D	D
result (V)	4.67	-7.01	2.353	-4.632	6.96	2.33	0.026

Figure 15, measurement results

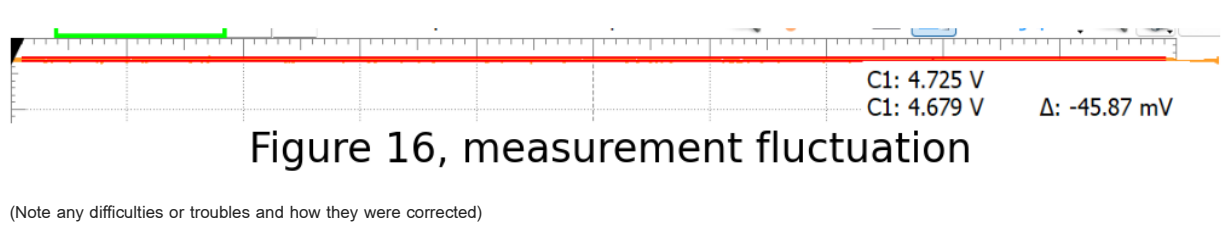


Figure 16, measurement fluctuation

(Note any difficulties or troubles and how they were corrected)

(Answer not conceptual questions)

The differences between the positive and negative leads is that the positive one [illegible]

My probe answers were quite close to the actual values.

3. DC Voltage Divider

3.1 Task #4: Unloaded Voltage Divider

(Build your design from prelab; include diagram and pic from AD3 breadout board and circuit)

Diagram will be inserted once I have the image upload figured out.

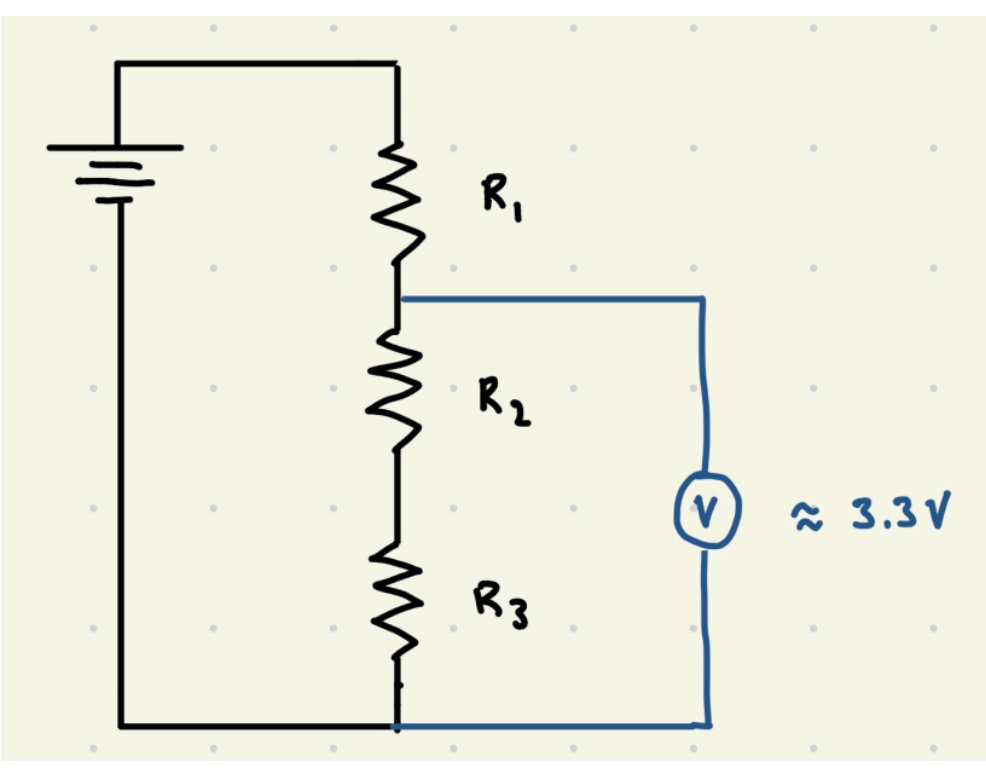


Figure 17, circuit diagram

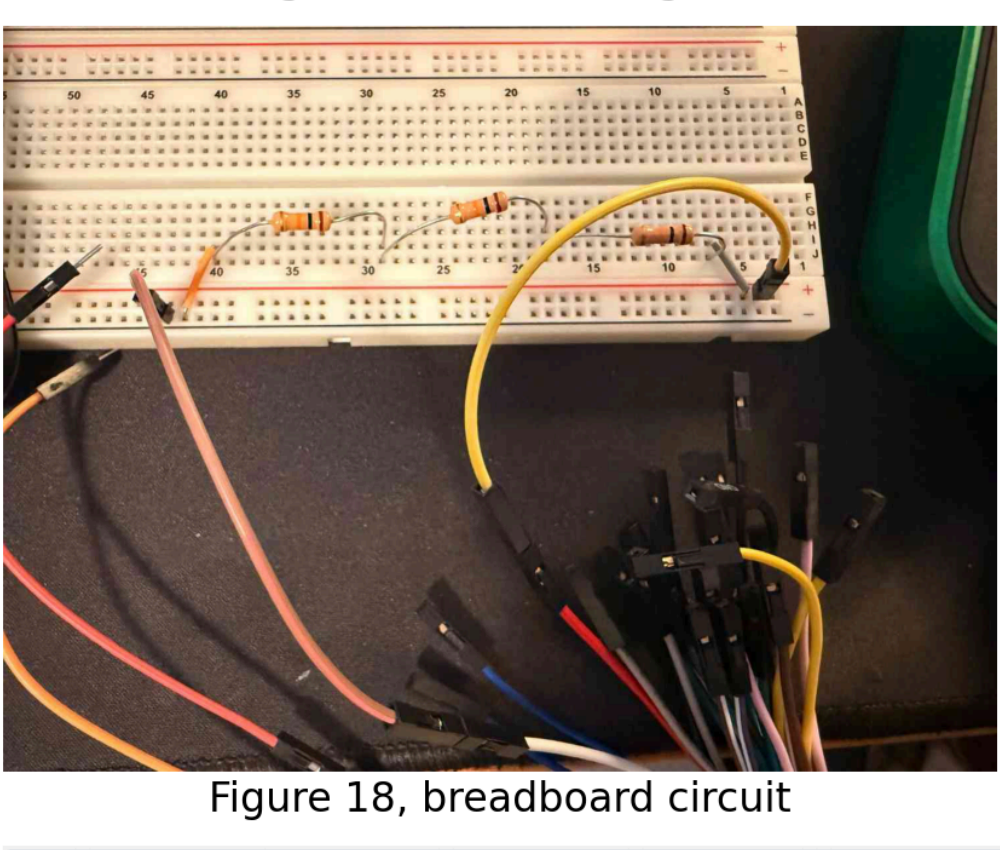


Figure 18, breadboard circuit

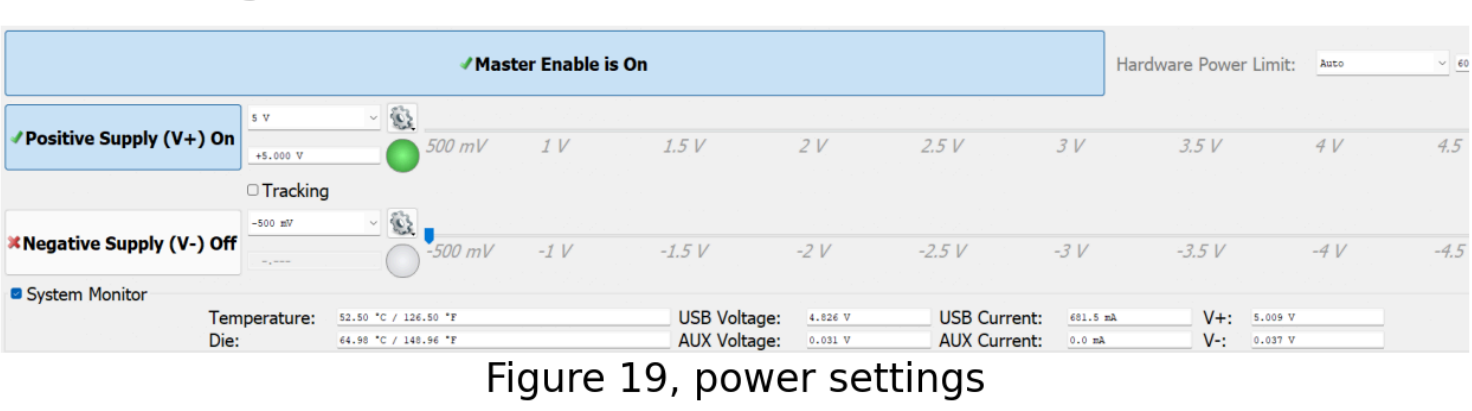


Figure 19, power settings

(Record measured Vout with uncertainty and compare to expected value with propagated error)

$$V_{out} = 3.3063V \pm 0.014V$$

How was this obtained? Well, if we look at Figure 20 below, we can see that there are two possible choices for uncertainty. One is the digital reading of the average, and the other is the actual fluctuation of the signal, which I have measured to have a range of 66.93mV. Since the fluctuation from the noise is the [illegible]

I think logically the value should be more like $V_{out} = 3.31V \pm 0.019V$. If uncertainty must be rounded to 1 significant figure (the rest is uncertain).

For the expected value of Vout (obtained by measuring each resistor and the voltage supply separately, then propagating the uncertainty for all measurements)

See image below! I have split up the process into different steps. Calculating each associated uncertainty, then the propagation in the first step of operations, then the propagation to the next step. Parts of the equation are colour coded for legibility.

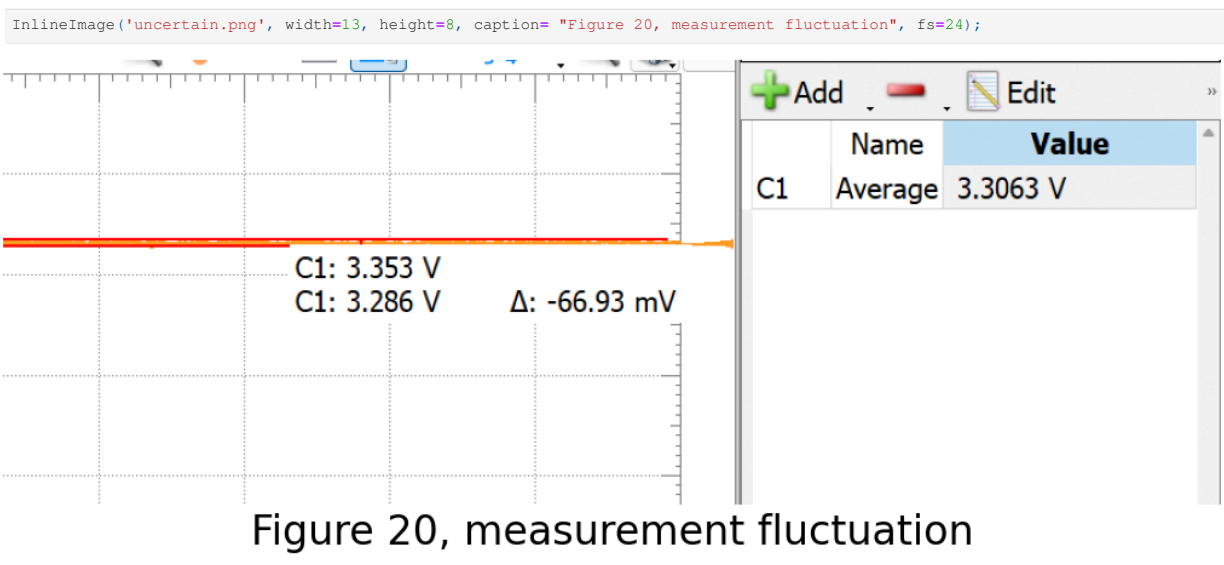
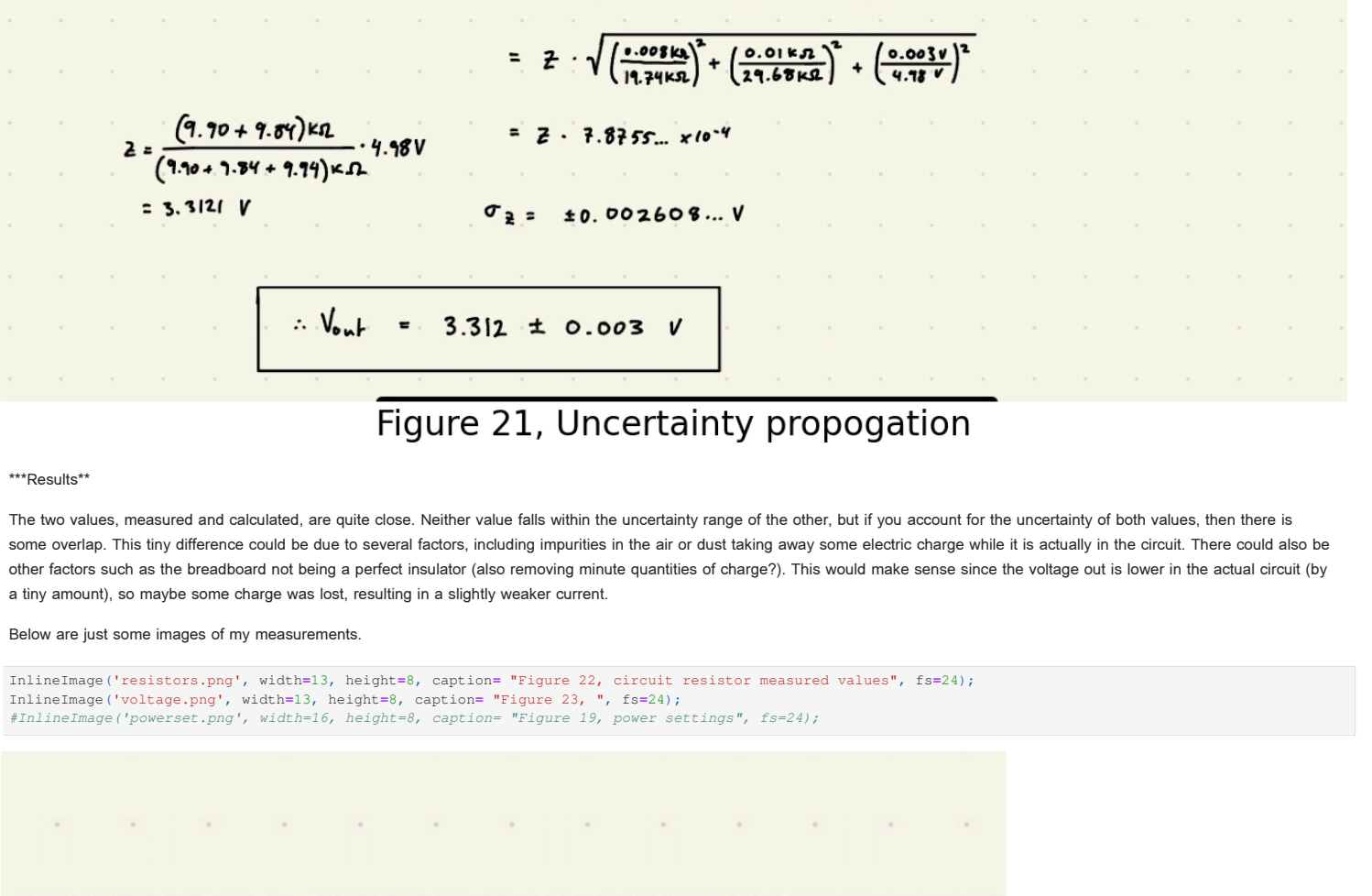


Figure 20, measurement fluctuation



Recall:
$V_{out} = \frac{R_2 + R_3}{R_1 + R_2 + R_3} \cdot V_{in}$
$R_2 + R_3 = a$
$R_1 + R_2 + R_3 = b$
$V_{in} = c$
$\sigma_a = \sqrt{(\sigma_{R_2})^2 + (\sigma_{R_3})^2}$
$\sigma_b = \sqrt{(\sigma_{R_1})^2 + (\sigma_{R_2})^2 + (\sigma_{R_3})^2}$
$z = \frac{a}{b} \cdot c$
$V_{out} = 3.312 \pm 0.003$

Figure 21, Uncertainty propogation

Results

The two values, measured and calculated, are quite close. Neither value falls within the uncertainty of the other, however. The difference could be due to several factors, including [illegible]

Below are some images of my measurements.

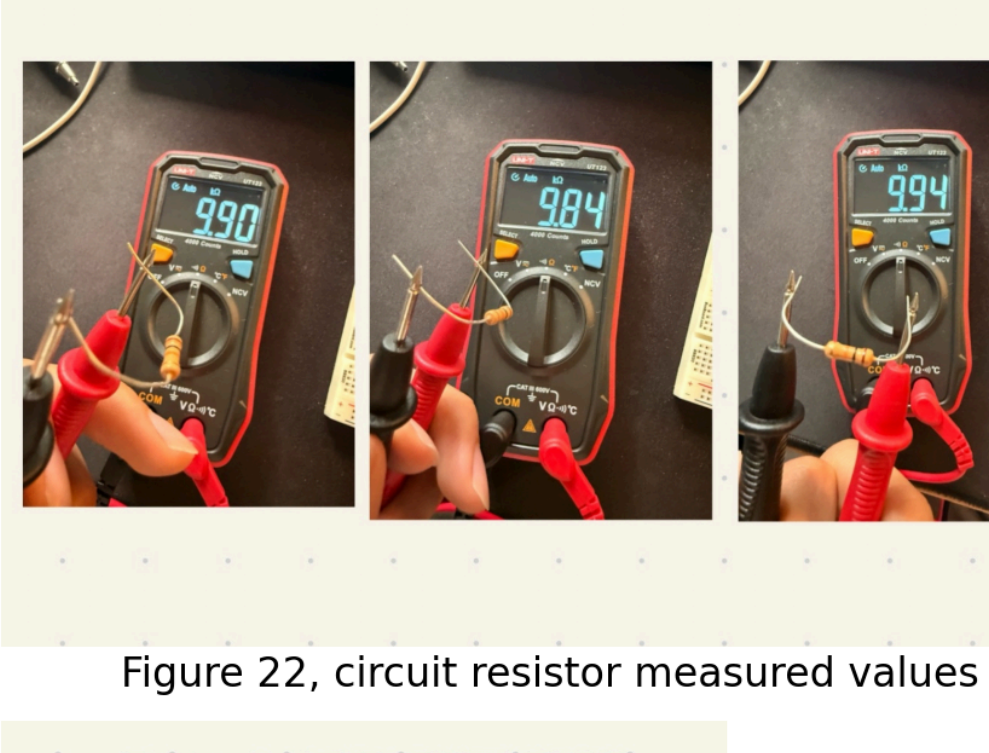


Figure 22, circuit resistor measured values

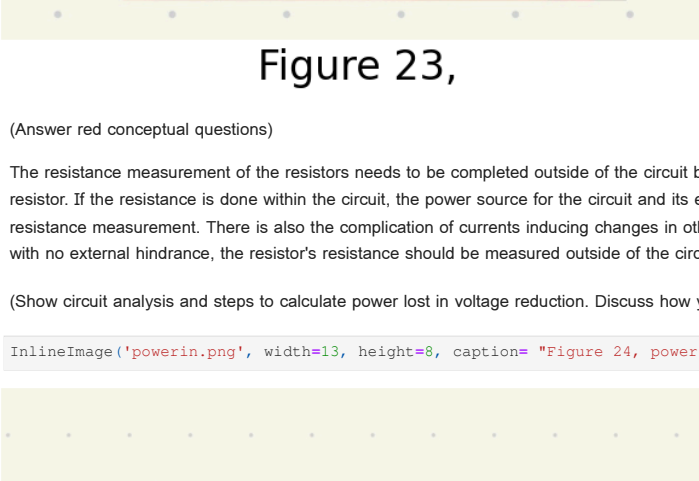
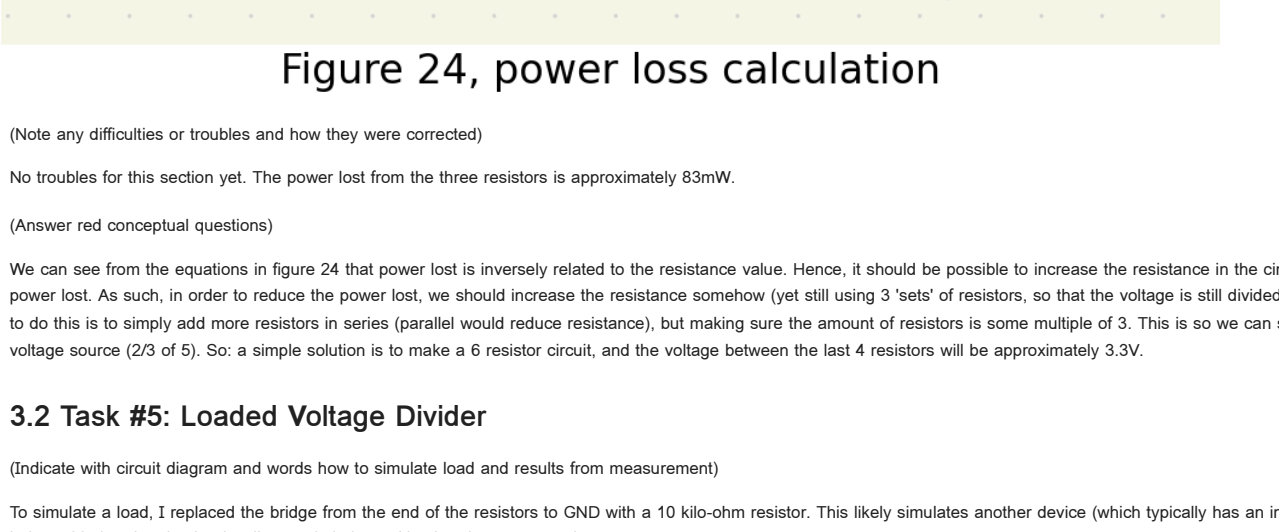


Figure 23,

(Answer not conceptual questions)

The resistance measurement of the resistors needs to be completed outside of the circuit because the resistor [illegible]

(Show circuit analysis and steps to calculate power lost in voltage reduction. Discuss how you could change circuit to reduce the power loss)



5V
10 kΩ
10 kΩ
10 kΩ
$I = 1.666... mA$
$P_T = 83.3566... mW$
Increase resistance to decrease power

Figure 24, power loss calculation

(Note any difficulties or troubles and how they were corrected)

No troubles for this part. The power lost from the three resistors is approximately 83mW.

We can see from the equations in figure 24 that power lost is inversely related to the resistance value. Hence, it should be possible to increase the resistance in the circuit to decrease the power lost [illegible]

3.2 Task #5: Loaded Voltage Divider

(Indicate with circuit diagram and breadboard pic and include results from measurement)

To simulate a load, I replaced the bottom two of the resistors with the 10kΩ [illegible]

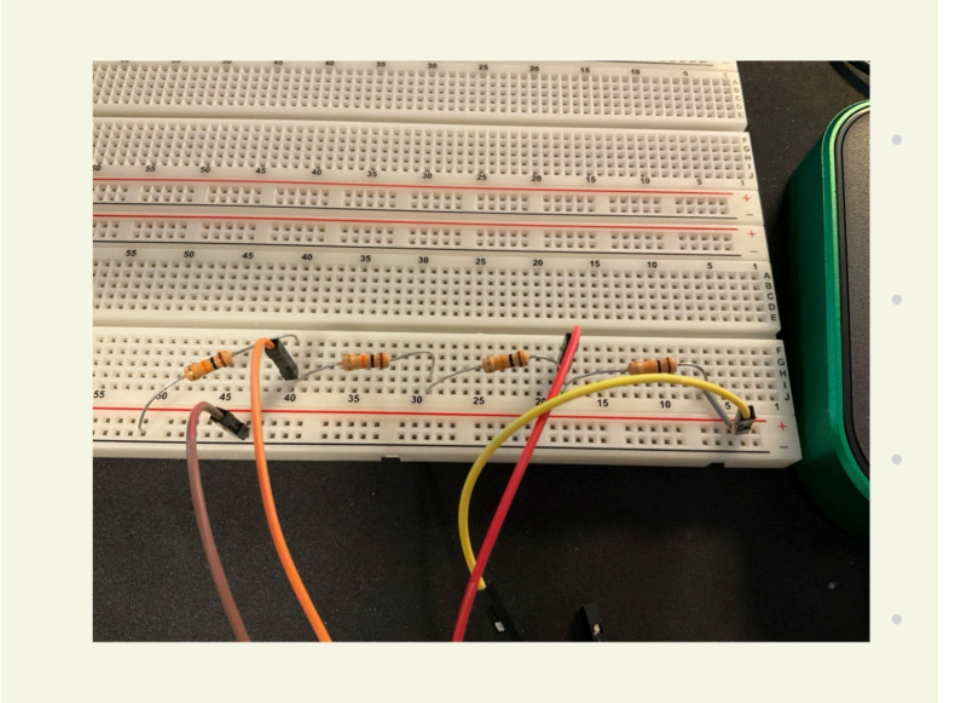


Figure 25, load simulation setup

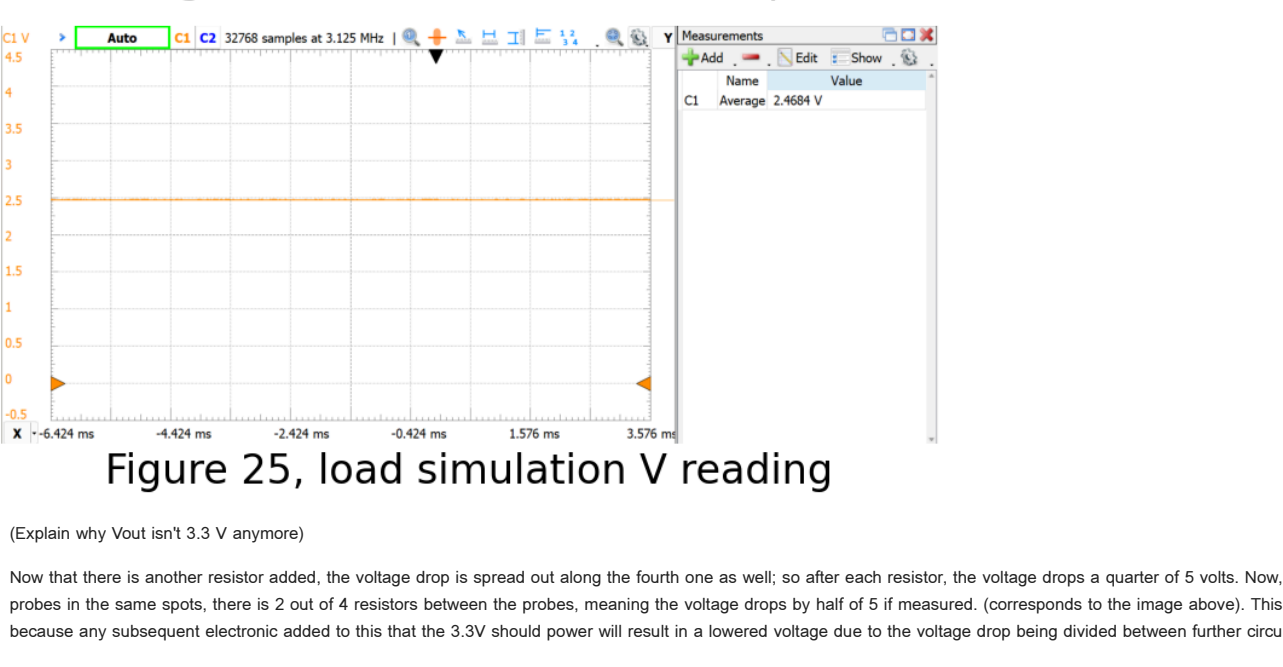


Figure 25, load simulation V reading

(Explain why load isn't 3.3 V anymore)

Now that there is another resistor added, the voltage drop is spread out evenly from each one [illegible]

(Describe how you changed its design, diagram it, and build it with pics, results)

To redesign the circuit, we need something that can guarantee [illegible]

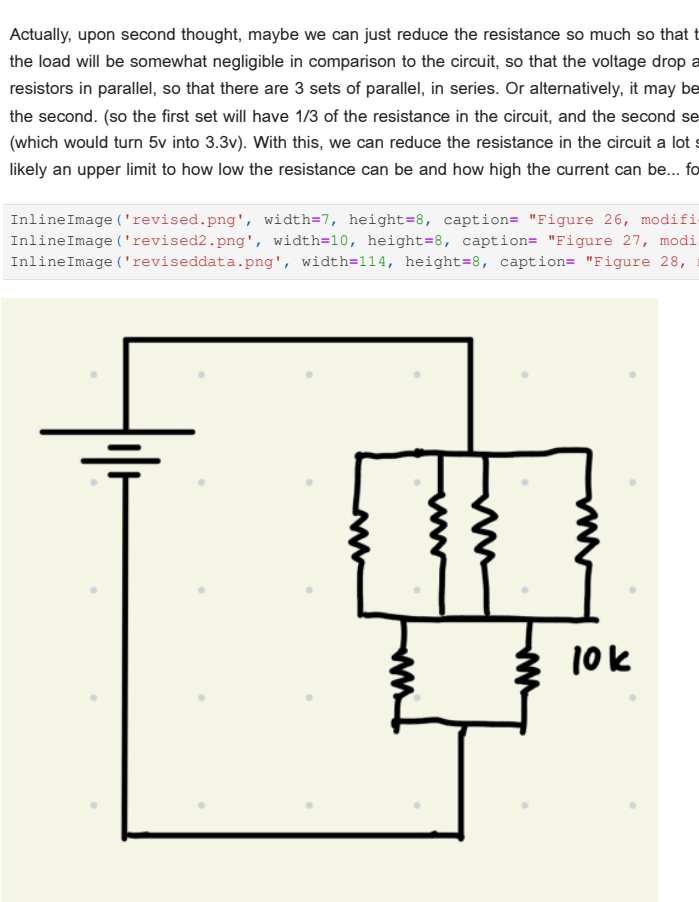


Figure 26, modified circuit diagram

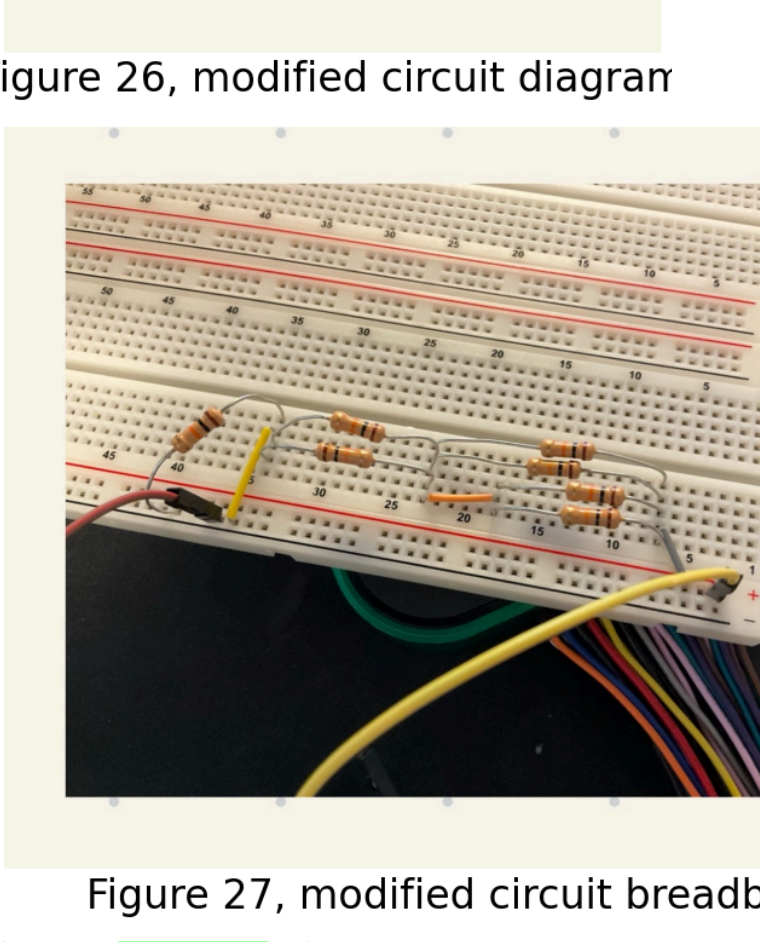


Figure 27, modified circuit breadboard

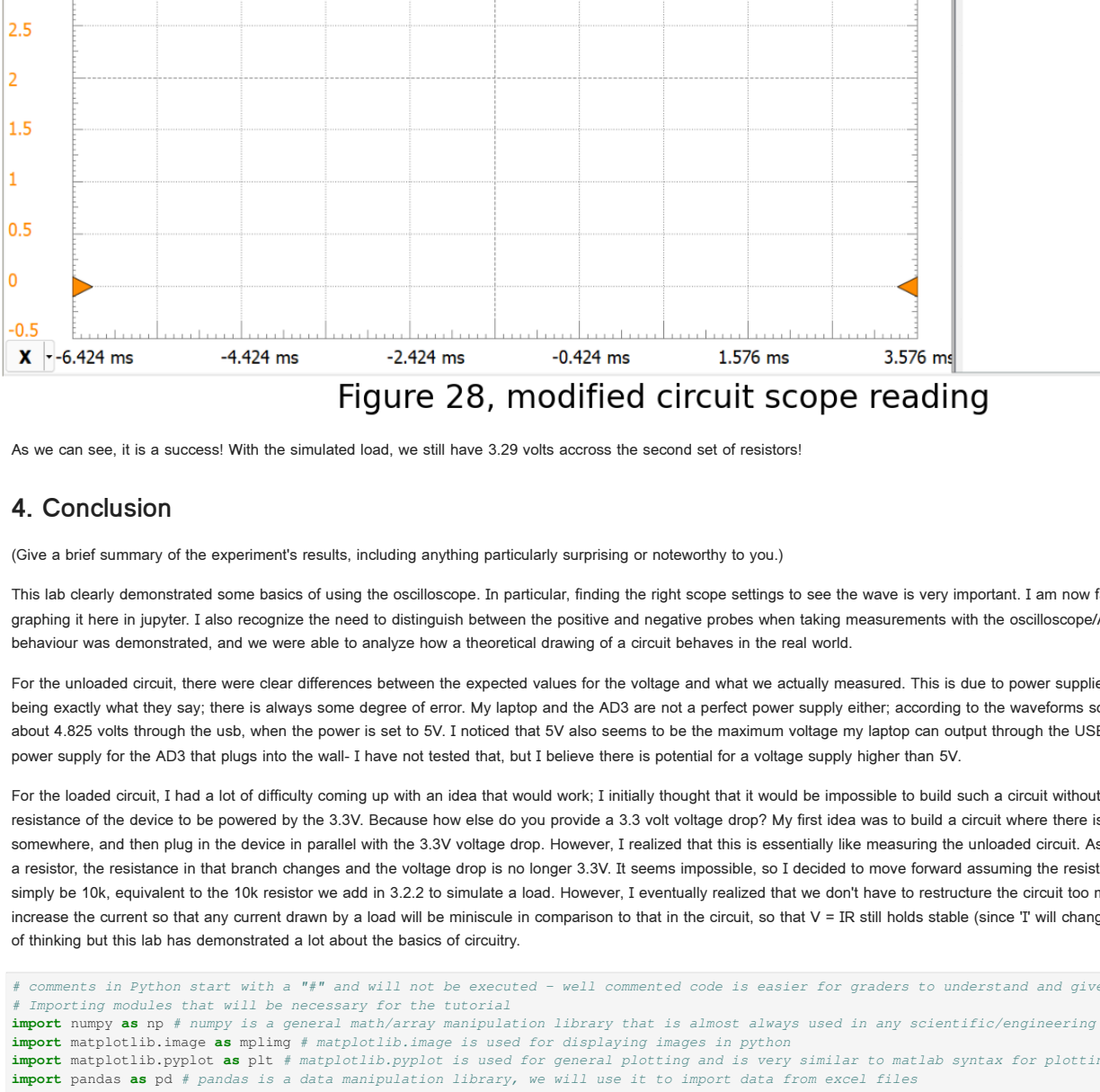


Figure 28, modified circuit scope reading

As we can see, it is a success! With the simulated load, we still have 3.29 volts across the second set of resistors!

4. Conclusion

(Give a brief summary of the experiment's results, including anything particularly surprising or noteworthy to you.)

The lab clearly demonstrated some basics of using the oscilloscope. In particular, finding the right scope settings to see the wave is very important. I am now familiar with importing data and graphing it in jupyter. I also recognize the need to distinguish between the positive and negative leads [illegible]

For the unloaded circuit, there were some clear differences between the expected values for the voltage [illegible] being exactly what they say; there is always some degree of error. My laptop and the AD3 are not a perfect power supply either [illegible]

For the loaded circuit, I tried a lot of different things to get the circuit to output 3.3V [illegible]